

The Modern Standard

VOL. 1, NO. 023

2026-03-30

COVER STORY

Money Origami, Flower Edition: 10 Different Ways to Fold a Dollar Bill into a Blossoming Bloom

The very first banknotes were used by the Chinese in the 7th century, during the Tang Dynasty.

Osas Obaiza · WonderHowTo

Before it was used as an actual currency, paper money was part of a deposit system in which merchants would leave large amounts of coins with a trusted associate and receive a paper receipt for the transaction. The reason was simple — the copper coins used as currency then were heavy. Fast forward about 300 years, and Jiaozi became the first official paper currency in the Sichuan capital of Chengdu. These notes were stamped with official seals to ensure no one made false copies. Even in the tenth century, counterfeiting was a concern.

Wikimedia CommonsToday, the word jiaozi is more likely to be associated with delicious Chinese dumplings, but paper money is still used in many countries.

Even so, with the widespread use of debit cards and the rising popularity of digital wallets, it may not be long before the dollar bill has had its day. So, what will we do with all that worthless paper when ...more

section-label([Features]) standard-article(title: [No, Tech Start-ups Aren't Taking Over the World], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([Looking at business news and stock market coverage over the past decade (including a few HBR articles), you'd think that just about every traditional, old-economy company has fallen prey – or will soon – to tech-focused competitors. But London Business School's Julian Birkinshaw says that story of disruption and destruction is overblown. His research into Fortune 500 and Global 500 organizations shows that, despite the rise of a few tech giants like Amazon and

standard-article(title: [Why We Should Pay More Attention to Departing CEOs], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([When news breaks of a CEO succession, much of the attention is given to the new leader and how they will change the company. But new research shows that the leave-taking process of the outgoing chief executive is often mishandled, with negative impacts on succession and the organization. Rebecca Slan Jerusalem, an executive director at Russell Reynolds Associates, and Navio Kwok, a leadership advisor at RRA, say that boards are often surprised when a CEO gives

brief-group(([**Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review:** Anne Wojcicki, CEO of 23andMe, spent a decade in healthcare and biotechnology before launching the DNA testing and analysis company in 2006. Her goal was twofold: to help individuals learn more about their own genetics, enabling them to pursue more personalized medical care, and to create a database of genetic information for commercial and academic researchers to promote broader improvements to the healthcare system. She speaks with HBR's Editor-in-Chief Adi Ignatius about tackling challenges in an emerging industry.], [

Google, many industries haven't been radically remade and that many older incumbents are still standing strong. He outlines the strategies they've used to do so, from fighting back to reinvention. Birkinshaw is the author of the HBR article "How Incumbents Survive and Thrive."],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 117, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

notice, and they often make that person feel excluded during the handoff process. The researchers share stories from the front lines about CEO psychology, best practices for outgoing leaders and their boards, and broader lessons for effective transitions. Jerusalem and Kwok wrote the HBR article "The Vital Role of the Outgoing CEO."],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 128, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

Daniel Jonas Roche, The Architect's Newspaper: A new distinction folded into Cooper Hewitt's annual Smithsonian National Design Awards Gala recognizes individual designers, living and deceased, as well as large corporations "for their lasting contributions to the field

The post Cooper Hewitt to honor Maya Lin, MillerKnoll, Candace Wheeler, and others at its Smithsonian National Design Awards Gala appeared first on The Architect's Newspaper .

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Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: David Burkus, author of "Under New Management", explains why some companies are taking extreme measures to limit electronic communication. Burkus is also a professor at Oral Roberts University and host of the podcast Radio Free Leader.

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Hadir Al Koshta, ArchDaily: © Alex Shoots Buildings

architects: System Recovery Architects

Location: Strážné, Czechia

Project Year: 2025

Photographs: Alex Shoots Buildings

Photographs: Vítězslav Kůstka

Area: 293.0 m2

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Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: Jeffrey Garten of Yale School of Management discusses how Genghis Khan, Mayer Amschel Rothschild, Margaret Thatcher, and others made the world more integrated. Garten is the author of "From Silk to Silicon: The Story of Globalization through Ten Extraordinary Lives".

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Christian Allaire, Vogue (runway): The shopping event offered unique vintage designer finds—but the line to get in was its very own street style spectacle.

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Miwa Negoro, ArchDaily: © Joon Hwan, Yoon

architects: DRAWING WORKS

Location: Jeju-si, South Korea

Project Year: 2025

Photographs: Joon Hwan, Yoon

Area: 10.0 m2

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Into the Gloss, Into the Gloss: “It’s fun trying new products, but I had to accept that my skin can’t take a lot. And honestly? It’s fine. I don’t know what I’m doing anyway.”

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Anna Cafolla, Vogue (runway): The fur-lined opera coat style has made a comeback via Conner Ives and vintage dealers, embracing yhr robe and its easy sense of glamour.

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Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: Dan McGinn, senior editor at Harvard Business Review, talks about what businesspeople can learn from how top performers and athletes prepare for their big moments. In business, a big sales meeting, presentation, or interview can be pivotal to success. The same goes for pep talks that motivate employees. McGinn talks about both the research and practical applications of mental preparation and motivation. He’s the author of the book, “Psyched Up: How the Science of Mental Preparation Can Help You Succeed.” His article, “The Science of Pep Talks,” is in the July-August 2017 issue of Harvard Business Review.

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Valentina Díaz, ArchDaily: © Mariela Apollonio
architects: TO DO hub d’arquitectura
Location: Jávea, España
Project Year: 2025
Photographs: Mariela Apollonio
Area: 327.0 m2
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Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: With more than \$7 billion in annual revenue and 24,000 employees, SAIC provides engineering, digital, AI, and mission support to defense, space, intelligence, and civilian customers. CEO Toni Townes-Whitley took the helm a year ago, after stints as a senior executive at Microsoft, CGI Federal, and Unisys. She discusses her approach to strategic transformation at SAIC through fine tuning and employee upskilling, rather than whole-sale change. She also shares how the company is incorporating cutting edge technologies, like generative AI, with appropriate safeguards for government clients.

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Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: Ursula Burns, CEO of Xerox from 2009 to 2016, rose from humble beginnings to become the first Black woman to lead a Fortune 500 company. In this interview with HBR editor-in-chief Adi Ignatius, she talks candidly about the frequent challenges and occasional advantages of being “the only” and explains why organizations need to do a better job of promoting both economic and racial equality – themes that also animate her new memoir, “Where You Are is Not Who You Are”.

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Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: We live in an age of data. But having powerful tools to gather employee feedback doesn't mean you'll get powerful results. It's challenging for executives to turn that feedback into substantive action. New research from Ethan Burris, professor of management at the McCombs School of Business at the University of Texas at Austin, sheds light on how to weed through all the data, make sure workers feel heard, and turn employee insights into real results. Burris is a coauthor of the HBR article “What Companies Get Wrong About the Employee Experience.”

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Harvard Business Review, Harvard Business Review: Eddie Yoon, author of “Superconsumers” and growth strategy expert at The Cambridge Group, explains how companies can find their most passionate customers and use their invaluable insights to improve products and attract new customers.

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Kim Velsey, Curbed: A decade ago, when the Jehovah's Witnesses sold off their prime real-estate portfolio in Brooklyn Heights, one of the prizes was a complex of old industrial buildings next to the Bro...
More »

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standard-article(title: [Dysfunctional Leadership Teams — and How to Fix Them], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([CEOs get a ton of credit or blame for a company's performance. But the entire leadership team is vital to success, and any dysfunction is often overlooked. Sometimes the CEOs leading them don't even see that they're not working. Thomas Keil, management professor at the University of Zurich, and Marianna Zangrillo, a partner at The Next Advisors, have interviewed more than 100 CEOs and senior executives. Their research identifies three main types of failing leadership teams: shark tanks, petting zoos, and mediocracies. And they identify the pitfalls of each pattern and how to turn those teams around. Keil and Zangrillo

standard-article(title: [Stop Initiative Overload], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([Rose Hollister and Michael Watkins, consultants at Genesis Advisers, argue that many companies today are taking on too many initiatives. Each manager might have their own pet projects they want to focus on, but that trickles down to lower level workers dealing with more projects at a time that they can handle, or do well. This episode also offers practical tips for senior-level leaders to truly prioritize the best initiatives at their company — or risk losing some of their top talent. Hollister and Watkins are the authors of the HBR article “Too Many Projects.” with. They are the authors of “Athena Rising: How and Why Men Should Mentor Women.”],),

wrote the HBR article “Why Leadership Teams Fail.”],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 108, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [Comedian Sarah Cooper On Bringing Humor to Any Career], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([It’s a cliché, but they say it’s best to write what you know. That was the case for comedian Sarah Cooper, who rose to viral social media fame in the Trump era through her lip sync TikTok videos. She formerly worked at Yahoo and Google, and she found her way into comedy, in part, by looking at and pointing out the absurdities of corporate culture. She speaks about how humor helped her manage a team, why she took the big risk to quit her job, and how she’s navigating the new work world of Hollywood. Cooper is the author of the forthcoming audio book “Let’s Catch Up Soon: How I Won Friends and Influenced People Against My Will.”],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 118, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [5 Weird & Easy Ways to Water Your Christmas Tree], author: [Heather Fishel], source-name: [WonderHowTo], images: (), paragraphs: ([Christmas trees, once decorated and brightly lit, are the penultimate holiday decoration, but authentic pines lose their brilliance fast without any nourishment. Plus, they are major fire hazards without regular hydration. But watering one requires a lot of sliding around on the floor, and it can be hard to tell how much water is in the bowl beneath the dark, prickly branches. These five hacks can help! 1. Break Out Your Beer BongWhat’s better than a tree watering device that requires zero bending and little effort? If you have a beer bong lying around or hiding in your box of old college stuff, pop it in your Christmas tree’s stand and create an instant irrigation system.], [By placing the end of the beer bong’s tubing into the tree stand’s bowl, holding the funnel outside of the branches, you can quickly pour in any amount of water and refresh your tree. Imgur2. Use a Funnel for a Quick Irrigation SystemHappen to have a funnel and some plastic piping in your garage? You’re just a few ...more],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 175, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [Sad, Mad, Anxious? How to Work Through Your ‘Big Feelings’], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([When things aren’t going well – in our own lives, our community, our country, or the world – it’s hard to be productive at work. Most of us also shy away from sharing what we’re feeling with colleagues and bosses. But when strong emotions like anxiety, anger, and despair hit you – due to problems at work or outside it – it’s important to recognize and thoughtfully address them. Liz Fosslien and Mollie West Duffy are coauthors of the book “Big Feelings: How to Be Okay When Things Are Not Okay,” and they share research-backed advice on how to do just that.],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 102, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

insert-map: (:), word-count: 110, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [Dematerialization and What It Means for the Economy — and Climate Change], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([Andrew McAfee, co-director of the MIT Initiative on the Digital Economy, explains how the U. S. economy is growing and actually using less and less stuff to do so. Thanks to new technologies, many advanced economies are reducing their use of timber, metals, fertilizer, and other resources. McAfee says this dematerialization trend is spreading to other parts of the globe. While it’s not happening fast enough to stop climate change, he believes it offers some hope for environmental protection when combined with effective public policy. McAfee is the author of the book “More from Less: The Surprising Story of How We Learned to Prosper Using Fewer Resources—and What Happens Next.”],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 109, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [Why Burnout Happens — and How Bosses Can Help], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([Christina Maslach, professor of psychology at the University of California, Berkeley, has been studying the causes of burnout, and its impact, for decades. She says that, in a year when everyone feels overwhelmed and exhausted, it’s more important than ever for managers to recognize when and why employees are suffering and take steps to solve those problems. In her framework, burnout stems from not only large workloads but also lack of control, community, and/or reward and values mismatches. She notes that leaders have the ability to pull many of those levers to help their workers. Maslach is the author of “The Truth About Burnout” and a forthcoming book on the topic.],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 111, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [A Debate Champion on How to Have More Productive Disagreements at Work], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([In an ideal world, professional conflicts are settled with thoughtful discussion and collaborative decision-making. But that’s not usually how it works. More typically, you see leaders - or the loudest voices - win out, leaving others resentful. And sometimes people don’t even try to hash out differences of opinion; they’d prefer to avoid a fight. Bo Seo, two-time world champion debater, says we can learn to disagree in healthier, more effective ways that ultimately generate better outcomes for teams, customers, and shareholders. Seo is also the author of the book “Good Arguments: How Debate Teaches us to Listen and Be Heard.”],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 101, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [Inside Companies that Get the Purpose-Profit Balance Right], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([Purpose has become a corporate buzz-word over the past decade. Leaders are embracing the idea that companies can't just do well financially; they also have to do good for society. But how many organizations are really walking the talk? Ranjay Gulati, professor at Harvard Business School, has studied how dozens of purpose-driven companies – from Etsy in the United States to Recruit in Japan – simultaneously pursue profits. He argues that while we all want a win-win, leaders must also sometimes learn to make thoughtful tradeoffs. Gulati is the author of the book “Deep Purpose: The Heart and Soul of High-Performance Companies” and the HBR article “The Messy but Essential Pursuit of Purpose.”],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 113, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [Applying Porter's Five Forces to Fix U.S. Politics], author: [Harvard Business Review], source-name: [Harvard Business Review], images: (), paragraphs: ([Katherine Gehl, a former CEO and the founder of the Institute for Political Innovation, and Michael Porter, a professor at Harvard Business School, apply his Five Forces framework to explain why U. S. politics are dysfunctional. They argue that the Republican and Democratic parties make up an industry duopoly with high barriers to entry and low consumer power, and that the resulting lack of competition incentivizes these two dominant players to avoid compromises with majority support. Gehl and Porter provide specific innovations on how to enhance competition and better serve the public, including nonpartisan primary elections and ranked-choice voting. Gehl and Porter are coauthors of the new book “The Politics Industry: How Political Innovation Can Break Partisan Gridlock and Save Our Democracy” and the HBR article “Fixing U. S.], [Politics.”],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 128, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

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The Rise of Corporate Inequality

Harvard Business Review

Stanford economist Nicholas Bloom discusses the research he's conducted showing what's really driving the growth of income inequality: a widening gap between the most successful companies and the rest, across industries. In other words, inequality has less to do with what you do for work, and more to do with which specific company you work for. The rising gap in pay between firms accounts for a large majority of the rise in income inequality overall. Bloom tells us why, and discusses some ways that companies and governments might address it. He's the author of the Harvard Business Review article, "Corporations in the Age of Inequality." For more, visit hbr.org/inequality.

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